

used, i.e. the type of content being shared by their children, among other things. Parents also have access to the educational insight system that let them know of their child's performance and improvements.

Nabi Tablet: <https://www.nabitablet.com/>

SOFTWARE RESOURCES

While there are many different toys to spark one's creative mind, there's no dearth of software available – for download and online – to help nurture programming and other tech skills in children. Indeed, good programming skills is one of the essentials to become technologically sound of mind. In the next few pages, we'll guide you through a few of the most popular software available to children.

1.Scratch

'Scratch' is one of the most popular coding resources available on the internet today. It's mainly meant to serve as a guideline for learning programming languages, using which they'll be able to create games, animation and digital stories. Initially started as an MIT Media Lab project in 2003, Scratch is now used by millions of people in over 150 different countries and 40 different languages. In reality, Scratch is a free, visual programming language meant to introduce kids to the Ruby on Rails framework. Using drag-and-drop blocks, users can digitally connect one block to another and thereby create a digital puzzle of sorts that can be compiled and run by the user. The user interface of Scratch is meant to be as child-friendly as possible. Children, as a rule, always prefer creating visual inventions that they can see and recognise. Hence, it's a simple, drag-and-drop interface with individual blocks representing blocks of code. The user logically connects each block of code to another to perform a certain action. Thus, Scratch was designed to be used by children who've had little or no programming experience whatsoever.

There's a wide Scratch online community, where users can upload their creations and – depending on the license – let other users download, edit the program and share the edits with others worldwide. There are also communities online that help a user upon any difficulty encountered. And while the target audience of Scratch is children, it's meant to be used by people of all age groups. Thus, the Scratch community is one of the largest programming communities online.

Visit the Scratch website at <http://scratch.mit.edu/>